

YES WE CLAN

This is one politically inclined family. **Valerie Vaz**, sister of Britain's longest serving MP of Indian origin Keith Vaz, may soon join her brother in Parliament. She is contesting in the forthcoming general elections as the Labour candidate from Walsall South. If elected, Valerie will become the UK's first Indian origin female lawmaker. The House of Commons will also see a rare brother-sister duo. "Keith's work ethic is always inspiring," says Valerie, who has attempted to stand for Parliament from a number of seats in the past. This time she's hoping to make political history.

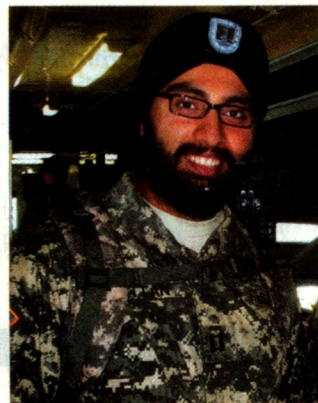


FAST LANE

The good times are rolling for actor **Shraddha Das**. Just six months after her acclaimed performance in the Telugu film *Arya 2*, the 22-year-old has already made her Bollywood debut. The Bengali girl shares screen space with veterans Nafisa Ali and Farooque Sheikh in Sanjay Puri's *Lahore*. Another Telugu film, *Maro Charitra*, is set for release. "I'm glad people are taking me seriously as an actor from my first film itself, but my dream is to work with Salman Khan," she says. Considering the verdict is not yet out, maybe she would do well to lower her expectations a notch or two.

Turban Legend

The US Army is not in the habit of bending the rules, but it has made an exception for **Tejdeep Singh Rattan**. The 31-year-old has become the first Sikh since 1981 to be allowed to wear a turban in the army. "I'm feeling very humbled. I'm a soldier. This has been my dream," says Rattan. While this is a mini-victory for the Sikh community, the ban on turbans in the army still remains. Rattan's is a one-off case due to his health care skills. But we doubt that will stop the turbaned men from cheering.



Missing in Action

She came, she acted, she disappeared. Ferena Wazier is the female lead in the film *Sadiyaan* but is missing from all the film promotions. The Kashmiri Muslim from the UK is awaiting her work permit so that she can return to India. Understandably, director Raj Kanwar is a worried man, "We are hoping she will be able to come at least for the premiere, God willing." Considering she has done other films in India like *Rang Rasiya*, we hope the visa officials have a change of heart. Till then, Luv Sinha will just have to do with Hema Malini and Rekha by his side.

